

A REASON TO STAY

Why some of Pilsen's young adults live with their parents.



TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Is your office a sitcom?

The Tribune's Christopher Borrelli worked at Toledo's Blade newspaper, the loose inspiration for the TV show "The Paper." **A+E**

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Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM



Faith leaders on the front lines

AS FEAR OF ICE ARRESTS GRIPS IMMIGRANTS ACROSS CHICAGO, THE REGION'S CLERGY OFFER RESOURCES AND MORAL SUPPORT

By Tess Kenny and Adriana Pérez | Chicago Tribune

As federal agents hurled tear gas and pepper spray through the night sky at protesters outside the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement holding facility in Broadview, the Rev. Quincy Worthington threw his arms out and used his body to shield those around him. Breathing through his own gas mask, the north suburban Presbyterian minister, who was wearing a clerical collar, hugged whoever he could and dragged them away from the fray.

His forearms burning from the pepper spray bullets, Worthington secured medical help, located water and, for the most part, listened to those protesting the Trump administration's immigration crackdown in the area.

"People just need to know that somebody's there for them," he said.

With escalating federal immigration enforcement operations across Chicago and its suburbs, and President Donald Trump's threats of sending the National Guard to quell crime, tension and fear have gripped those opposed to his administration and its "Operation Midway Blitz," which officials say has resulted in more than 550 immigration arrests in the Chicago area this month.

Trump's actions have prompted everyday citizens to confront immigration agents during arrests, activists to hold weekly news conferences and dozens of demonstrations and

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Above: The Rev. Carmelo Mendez, center, walks in a procession for migrants from St. Oscar Romero in the New City neighborhood to St. Rita of Cascia in the Chicago Lawn neighborhood as part of an observance of National Migration Week by the Archdiocese of Chicago on Wednesday. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Budget to test mayor's savvy

Johnson faces political minefield to close \$1.15B funding gap

By Alice Yin, A.D. Quig and Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

The leaves are starting to change in Chicago, and Mayor Brandon Johnson is about to kick off a fall budget fight that will test his political savvy at least as much as his ability to balance the city's books.

To close a \$1.15 billion 2026 funding gap by the end of the year, the freshman chief executive will have to dance through a minefield. He faces a restive crew of aldermen who are deeply skeptical of the mayor's political standing, labor groups whose continued support may hinge on Johnson sparing their city union jobs and grassroots activists trying to push him left to live up to his "tax the rich" pledges while the business community chafes against those hopes.

Looming over all of these dynamics is the countdown to 2027, when the mayor and aldermen are on the ballot and budget decisions for 2026 such as tax increases will still be fresh in Chicagoans' minds.

"Voters' memories are short. ... The closer you get to an election, the more in focus those decisions become," Aviva Bowen, a Democratic political strategist, said. "The budget crisis wasn't created overnight, but the mayor's shaky standing with voters and City Council has completely poisoned the process, and what you have now is the perfect storm at the worst possible time."

Johnson's ongoing opposition to raising property taxes or instituting layoffs — traditionally two reliable but politically perilous ways to fill the budget hole — along with his uneasy relationships with many aldermen and Springfield leaders will likely complicate his path to the 26 council votes he needs. The final version of the 2026 budget passed by aldermen may end up unrecognizable from

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IN THE SPOTLIGHT'S GLARE

Activist turned politician faces new scrutiny as lawsuit alleges sexual assault of teenage girl

By Alison Flowers and Gregory Royal Pratt
Chicago Tribune

Natalya Malone remembers the vigil for her 15-year-old son. The night after Deontae was slain in 2011, friends and family showed up at 65th and Mozart streets in the Marquette Park neighborhood to pray for peace.

So did Andrew Holmes, a prominent anti-violence activist and future village of Dolton trustee

who has approached families at crime scenes for years, often briefing reporters and offering financial rewards for finding the killers. At Deontae's vigil, Holmes "just popped up" and asked questions about her son, Malone recalled.

"After that, he disappeared," Malone said. "He never came around."

For more than a decade, Holmes has become so well-known for anti-violence work that former Chicago Mayor Rahm Emanuel

once declared an "Andrew Holmes Day." TV host Steve Harvey hailed him as a champion of crime victims and former FBI Director James Comey honored Holmes with a national award for community leadership.

But behind the scenes, Malone and some other community members say his actions left them feeling revictimized and exploited as he raised his own profile without delivering the help he promised. Their frustration offers insight into the complex world of community activists who work to

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Asha Gant is suing anti-violence activist Andrew Holmes, alleging that he sexually assaulted her when she was a teenager. **CHRIS SWEDA/TRIBUNE**

Israeli strikes, gunfire kill 59

International pressure grows for a ceasefire, but Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu remains defiant about continuing the war in Gaza. **Nation & World**

Lawsuit hits Loyola Medical

The suit accuses Loyola University Medical Center of performing organ transplant on unsuitable patients to boost Medicare billing. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Playoff baseball returns to Wrigley

The Cubs on Saturday clinched home field for the NL wild-card series. All games in the best-of-three series against the Padres will be at Wrigley. **Chicago Sports**

